REG-03 | Therapist only - all age groups

Expanding my response options

1 | Purpose, fit and boundaries

Purpose of this unit

Identify more than one response option and choose a tool based on the situation, need and safety. Assess usefulness by what the response enables, without requiring the feeling to disappear for success.

Choice and adaptation

Choose this sheet following professional assessment and with consent. The person may skip questions, answer aloud, or choose another tool. This is proposed original material for review; it provides no score, diagnosis, or promise of an outcome.

Boundaries specific to this unit

Do not tell someone to stay in danger to calm down, force breathing, touch or leaving the room, or make a break a punishment. Immediate harm requires a separate safety response, not completing a form.

Reusing existing material

REG-01 identifies an initial response, and REG-02 explores needs and context. Here we compare alternatives and expected outcomes; use an existing event map rather than repeating it.

A fictional example for discussion

Fictional example: Guy struggles to continue a conversation when overloaded. He chooses to request an agreed break and write what matters to say; the goal is to regain choice, not erase anger.

> Draft for administrator review. Clinical review and final rights approval are still pending.

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Working together with the worksheet

2 | A conversation about one situation

Opening

Choose a situation the person wants to explore. It need not be the hardest situation. Check that the question is understood and the wording fits the person; their account comes before the therapist's interpretation.

1 | Question for discussion

When do I tend to respond in only one way?

2 | Question for discussion

What is my goal, and what are my safety boundaries?

3 | Question for discussion

What alternatives do I have, including asking for help or a break?

4 | Question for discussion

What alternative fits now, and what might it cost?

5 | Question for discussion

How will I assess whether it supported the need or goal?

Closing

Summarize what became clearer and what remains open. Use the existing SES-S01 and SES-S02 for the session framework. There is no need to repeat an assessment or plan already recorded.

Possible difficulties

If a tool does not help, explore fit and conditions rather than demanding more effort. If a break is unsafe or impossible, seek other support; no single rule fits every situation.

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Adapting for four age groups

3 | Age is a starting point, not an assumption about ability

CH | Children, approximately ages 6 to 11

Offer two concrete options, such as asking for help or going with an adult to a comfortable place. Do not send a child away to calm down alone as a condition for help.

Offer one question at a time with little writing. Adult support must not replace the child's own voice.

TE | Adolescents, approximately ages 12 to 17

Agree how a break can work in the setting and how to return to the conversation if appropriate. Do not require full emotional control before listening to what the person says.

Agree in advance what will be shared and with whom, and explain the privacy limits in this setting. Do not promise absolute confidentiality.

AD | Adults

Distinguish personal action from work or relationship constraints. Coordinating support rather than self-calming may be the appropriate tool.

OA | Older adults

Do not assume movement or breathing exercises are suitable. Ask what is comfortable and accessible, and allow conversation or rest.

Offer reading support, time, and conversation according to preference. Choose help from another person together with the participant, respecting their privacy.

> Each age version needs its own review. Approval of one version does not automatically approve the others.

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Practice, review and next steps

4 | Shared choice and learning from the attempt

Before offering practice sheet P

Choose a safe, suitable opportunity with the person, or use only a fictional conversation in the session. Do not provoke anger or create conflict to complete the sheet. Skipping, stopping and seeking help are options. Harm and threats need an appropriate response before communication practice.

At the next session

Explore changes in choice, communication or protection of a need. A strong feeling can coexist with a useful response; do not judge success only by calmness.

Professional and technical records

Each version has a separate review record covering age suitability, originality, rights, and fictional filling. Reviewer and date fields remain blank until assigned. File checks or a code merge are not clinical approval. Clinical information stays only in the authorized setting, outside the code repository.

Background references

The following links were used for background only. Questions and adaptations were written afresh for the expansion plan; no questionnaire, scale, or protocol was copied. Adult sources do not validate the child versions. This material makes no claim about session count or treatment effectiveness.

www.nhs.uk/mental-health/feelings-symptoms-behaviours/feelings-and-symptoms/anger/

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